

Apple Homekit

If there's an odd-one-out in this list, it's Apple Homekit. Because it's not a communications protocol. But still, we think it merits a mention here if for nothing else because of all the media frenzy it has stirred up. And, since it comes from Apple one of the most innovative companies in the world.

HomeKit was announced by Apple at the company's Developers Conference in 2014. HomeKit is a software framework which enables developers to build smart home devices which would directly connect to the iPad and iPhone and could be controlled using a dedicated app.

The basic fact is that HomeKit will be a conduit for various wireless technologies. HomeKit-approved devices will make use of Bluetooth and Wi-Fi as their primary interfaces. Also, reports suggest that a ZigBee/Z-Wave bridge are also on the cards. Apple has already approved an Insteon-HomeKit. Putting together such facts we can see that compatibility probably won't be the primary issue with HomeKit devices.

At present, there aren't that many HomeKit integrated products in the market though many are the device manufacturers who work to integrate HomeKit into their products.



HomeKit

Not just a protocol but a
software framework

Recommended connection

There are already quite a few popular communication protocols competing for your attention in the home automation market. And many more are coming. It would be imprudent to say that there exists one protocol that towers above all else – especially in this early stage of the market's evolution. However, that's not to say that you can't make useful recommendations based on the extent to which you plan to automate your home. Here are our picks:

If this is the first time that you are getting your house automated, you might as well go with Z-Wave or ZigBee. Both these protocols are fast and wireless. They also give you great range. Then there's also the fact that there are hundreds of different products compatible with these.

On the other hand, if your home has an older X10 system, it's safe to opt for Insteon. Insteon gives you the option to migrate to wireless. It's true that Insteon doesn't have as many compatible devices as ZigBee or Z-Wave, but there are still many good products to choose from for Insteon. **d**